

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Regionalism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Four concepts examiners deliberately blur?

A. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. B. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. C. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. D. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically.

Answer: A. Explanation: This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Four concepts examiners deliberately blur?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. C. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. D. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism.

Answer: B. Explanation: This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four concepts examiners deliberately blur?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. C. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. D. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist.

Answer: C. Explanation: This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four concepts examiners deliberately blur?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. C. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. D. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions.

Answer: D. Explanation: This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Diversity?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. B. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. C. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. D. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference.

Answer: A. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Diversity?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. C. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. D. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically.

Answer: B. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development.

The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Diversity?

A. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. B. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. C. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. D. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference.

Answer: C. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Diversity?

A. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. B. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. C. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. D. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development.

Answer: D. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Regionalism?

A. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. B. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. C. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. D. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist.

Answer: A. Explanation: Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Regionalism?

A. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. B. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. C. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. D. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph.

Answer: B. Explanation: Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Regionalism?

A. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. B. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. C. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: C. Explanation: Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Regionalism?

A. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. B. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. C. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. D. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism.

Answer: D. Explanation: Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Sub-regionalism?

A. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. B. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. C. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. D. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Sub-regionalism?

A. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. B. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. C. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sub-regionalism?

A. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. B. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. C. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sub-regionalism?

A. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. B. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. C. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. D. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Regional disparity?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. C. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. D. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph.

Answer: A. Explanation: Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Regional disparity?

A. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. B. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. C. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. D. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph.

Answer: B. Explanation: Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Regional disparity?

A. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. B. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. C. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. D. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved.

Answer: C. Explanation: Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Regional disparity?

A. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. B. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. C. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. D. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference.

Answer: D. Explanation: Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Causal independence of the two axes?

A. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. B. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. C. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: A. Explanation: The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Causal independence of the two axes?

A. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. B. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. C. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: B. Explanation: The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Causal independence of the two axes?

A. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. B. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. C. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. D. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule.

Answer: C. Explanation: The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Causal independence of the two axes?

A. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. B. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. C. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. D. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist.

Answer: D. Explanation: The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct

but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The exact test in the 2024 demand?

A. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. B. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. C. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The exact test in the 2024 demand?

A. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. B. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. C. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. D. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The exact test in the 2024 demand?

A. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. B. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. C. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. D. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The exact test in the 2024 demand?

A. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. D. The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Identity-driven regionalism?

A. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. B. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. C. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. D. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule.

Answer: A. Explanation: Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Identity-driven regionalism?

A. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. B. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. C. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. D. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder.

Answer: B. Explanation: Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Identity-driven regionalism?

A. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. D. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.

Answer: C. Explanation: Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Identity-driven regionalism?

A. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. B. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. C. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. D. Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.

Answer: D. Explanation: Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Disparity-driven regionalism?

A. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. B. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. C. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. D. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Disparity-driven regionalism?

A. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. B. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. C. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. D. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Disparity-driven regionalism?

A. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. D. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

Answer: C. Explanation: Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Disparity-driven regionalism?

A. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. D. Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved.

Answer: D. Explanation: Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Compounded grievance?

A. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. D. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.

Answer: A. Explanation: A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Compounded grievance?

A. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. B. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. C. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. D. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed.

Answer: B. Explanation: A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Compounded grievance?

A. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. D. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

Answer: C. Explanation: A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Compounded grievance?

A. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. B. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. C. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. D. A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule.

Answer: D. Explanation: A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Movement forms?

A. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. D. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Movement forms?

A. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. B. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. C. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. D. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

Answer: B. Explanation: Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Movement forms?

A. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. B. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. C. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. D. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

Answer: C. Explanation: Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Movement forms?

A. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. B. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. C. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. D. Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder.

Answer: D. Explanation: Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Accommodation as the Indian record?

A. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. D. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level.

Answer: A. Explanation: Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Accommodation as the Indian record?

A. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. B. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. C. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. D. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

Answer: B. Explanation: Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Accommodation as the Indian record?

A. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. B. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. C. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. D. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level.

Answer: C. Explanation: Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Accommodation as the Indian record?

A. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. B. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. C. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. D. Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.

Answer: D. Explanation: Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies States Reorganisation Act, 1956?

A. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. B. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. C. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. D. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level.

Answer: A. Explanation: The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under States Reorganisation Act, 1956?

A. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. B. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. C. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. D. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion.

Answer: B. Explanation: The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of States Reorganisation Act, 1956?

A. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. B. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. C. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. D. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy.

Answer: C. Explanation: The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about States Reorganisation Act, 1956?

A. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. B. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. C. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. D. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed.

Answer: D. Explanation: The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies SDG India Index as a disparity source?

A. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. B. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. C. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. D. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under SDG India Index as a disparity source?

A. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. B. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. C. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. D. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of SDG India Index as a disparity source?

A. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. B. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. C. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about SDG India Index as a disparity source?

A. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. B. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. C. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. D. The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Index score against lived disparity?

A. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. B. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. C. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. D. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation

redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy.

Answer: A. Explanation: A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Index score against lived disparity?

A. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. B. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. C. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. D. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion.

Answer: B. Explanation: A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Index score against lived disparity?

A. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. B. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. C. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: C. Explanation: A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Index score against lived disparity?

A. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. B. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. C. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. D. A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level.

Answer: D. Explanation: A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Indicator families for a seriousness verdict?

A. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. B. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. C. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. D. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion.

Answer: A. Explanation: Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Indicator families for a seriousness verdict?

A. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. B. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. C. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence

rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: B. Explanation: Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Indicator families for a seriousness verdict?

A. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. B. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. C. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. D. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected.

Answer: C. Explanation: Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Indicator families for a seriousness verdict?

A. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. B. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. C. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. D. Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion.

Answer: D. Explanation: Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Diagnosis-to-instrument matching?

A. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. B. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. C. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Diagnosis-to-instrument matching?

A. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. B. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. C. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Diagnosis-to-instrument matching?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. B. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. C. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. D. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that

Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected.

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Diagnosis-to-instrument matching?

A. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. B. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. C. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. D. The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The cost of creating a new unit?

A. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. B. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. C. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: A. Explanation: Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The cost of creating a new unit?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. B. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. C. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. D. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The cost of creating a new unit?

A. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. B. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. C. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. D. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The cost of creating a new unit?

A. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. B. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. C. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. D. Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Cross-owner boundaries?

A. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. B. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. C. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. D. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions.

Answer: A. Explanation: A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Cross-owner boundaries?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. B. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. C. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. D. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions.

Answer: B. Explanation: A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Cross-owner boundaries?

A. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. B. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. C. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development

owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. D. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development.

Answer: C. Explanation: A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Cross-owner boundaries?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. C. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. D. A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Answer: D. Explanation: A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. B. This owner separates four concepts that are routinely conflated: diversity as the presence of distinct regional identities, regionalism as political assertion of a region's identity and interest, sub-regionalism as assertion within an already-recognised region, and regional disparity as unequal development outcomes between regions. C. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. D. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism.

Answer: A. Explanation: Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. B. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. C. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. D. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism.

Answer: B. Explanation: Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. B. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. C. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. D. Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism.

Answer: C. Explanation: Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. B. The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. C. Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. D. Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness,

routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected.

Answer: D. Explanation: Two General Studies Paper-I demands are routed to this topic: the 2020 demand on regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness, routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demand on regional disparity against diversity, routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to this Basic owner and confirmed verbatim in the locally held official 2024 question paper including a printed capitalisation irregularity that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Two direct General Studies Paper-I Mains demands are routed to this topic and each is recorded with its exact routing status. The 2020 Q10 demand arguing that regionalism in India appears to be a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness is routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner, while the Core owner's own answer-architecture table records that Core routing supersedes that pointer, so it is answered here from the Basic spine; the locally held official 2020 paper is a scanned image from which reliable English text cannot be extracted, so the audited ledger's neutral demand rendering is used and no verbatim wording is claimed for that year. The 2024 Q17 demand on regional disparity, its difference from diversity and the seriousness of the issue in India is routed in the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger to this Basic owner, and its wording was confirmed in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I, including a printed capitalisation irregularity in the third sentence that is reproduced rather than silently corrected. No marking scheme, official key or model answer of the Union Public Service Commission is held locally, and none is reproduced or inferred. No state ranking, index score, per-capita income or infrastructure figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Define the central concept and separate it from the nearest social or legal category. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Trace the historical and institutional setting instead of assuming a timeless practice. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Explain the norm, incentive, network, power or agency mechanism producing the outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Use one named Indian community, movement, region, institution or source-dated dataset. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualify the pattern through intersectionality, regional variation, causation and implementation limits. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I PYQ (15 marks, verbatim):** "What is regional disparity? How does it differ

from diversity? How serious is the issue of regional disparity in India?" The expected answer: define regional disparity precisely (unequal development outcomes between regions), distinguish it sharply from diversity (cultural difference, which need not imply unequal outcomes), and assess seriousness using development-indicator evidence (income, infrastructure, human development gaps between better- and worse-performing states/regions), concluding that disparity remains a serious governance challenge requiring targeted balanced-development policy, separate from any policy response to diversity itself.

- **ANALYSIS:** Two states sharing similar linguistic-cultural heritage but showing sharply different

per-capita income and infrastructure levels illustrate disparity existing independently of diversity, directly supporting the 2024 PYQ's distinction.

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (15 marks):** define regional disparity, distinguish it precisely from

diversity with a paired example (culturally similar but economically disparate regions), and assess seriousness using dated development-indicator evidence, concluding with a balanced-development policy recommendation.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024

- **Paper(s):** GS-I

- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	17	Regional disparity versus diversity in India	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Regional disparity versus diversity in India

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (15 marks, verbatim):** "What is regional disparity? How does it differ from diversity? How serious is the issue of regional disparity in India?" Analytical route: (a) define both terms precisely; (b) apply the independence argument with a paired boundary-case example (diversity-without-disparity and disparity-without-diversity); (c) assess seriousness using dated NITI SDG India Index evidence while flagging its sub-state-masking limitation; (d) conclude that disparity remains a serious, distinct governance challenge requiring a redistribution-focused response, separate from any identity-recognition response to diversity.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-I	10	Regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness	Argue · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Regionalism as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q10

Demand: Audited ledger demand rendering: regionalism in India as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness. Argue, 10 marks, 150 words.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner, with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes. The locally held official 2020 paper is a scanned image without reliable English text extraction, so the ledger rendering is used and no verbatim wording is claimed.

Model solution: Accept the proposition partly and then bound it, because an argue directive at ten marks rewards a stated pathway and one honest limitation rather than a survey. Define the terms in the first two lines. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across regions, while regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources. Argue the pathway that the proposition assumes. Cultural distinctiveness becomes politically salient when a group organises around it and seeks recognition, linguistic status or symbolic representation, and identity-driven regionalism of this kind can arise even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, which is exactly what the phrase cultural assertiveness describes. Then argue the limitation, which is where the mark difference sits. Regionalism also arises from regional disparity, meaning unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity, and disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate; since diversity and disparity are causally independent axes, cultural assertiveness cannot be the

sole explanation. Add the form correction that this demand usually attracts. Statehood demand, autonomy demand and secessionist demand are three distinct forms rather than a compulsory escalation ladder, most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, and the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 is the classical example of accommodation through recognition rather than suppression. Conclude that rising cultural assertiveness is one genuine pathway to regionalism but not the whole explanation, that the correct response is diagnosis-specific with recognition for identity grievance and redistribution for material grievance, and that a constitutional statehood demand is not on that account anti-national.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q10", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Accept the proposition partly and then bound it, because an argue directive at ten marks rewards a stated pathway and one honest limitation rather than a survey. Define the terms in the first two lines. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across regions, while regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources. Argue the pathway that the proposition assumes. Cultural distinctiveness becomes politically salient when a group organises around it and seeks recognition, linguistic status or symbolic representation, and identity-driven regionalism of this kind can arise even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, which is exactly what the phrase cultural assertiveness describes. Then argue the limitation, which is where the mark difference sits. Regionalism also arises from regional disparity, meaning unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity, and disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate; since diversity and disparity are causally independent axes, cultural assertiveness cannot be the sole explanation. Add the form correction that this demand usually attracts. Statehood demand, autonomy demand and secessionist demand are three distinct forms rather than a compulsory escalation ladder, most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, and the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 is the classical example of accommodation through recognition rather than suppression. Conclude that rising cultural assertiveness is one genuine pathway to regionalism but not the whole explanation, that the correct response is diagnosis-specific with recognition for identity grievance and redistribution for material grievance, and that a constitutional statehood demand is not on that account anti-national.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Audited ledger demand rendering: regionalism in India as a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness. Argue, 10 marks, 150 words. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication.

Qualification: State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Accept the proposition partly and then bound it, because an argue directive at ten marks rewards a stated pathway and one honest limitation rather than a survey. Define the terms in the first two lines. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across regions, while regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources. Argue the pathway that the proposition assumes. Cultural distinctiveness becomes politically salient when a group organises around it and seeks recognition, linguistic status or symbolic representation, and identity-driven regionalism of this kind can arise even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, which is exactly what the phrase cultural assertiveness describes. Then argue the limitation, which is where the mark difference sits. Regionalism also arises from regional disparity, meaning unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity, and disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate; since diversity and disparity are causally independent axes, cultural assertiveness cannot be the sole explanation. Add the form correction that this demand usually attracts. Statehood

demand, autonomy demand and secessionist demand are three distinct forms rather than a compulsory escalation ladder, most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, and the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 is the classical example of accommodation through recognition rather than suppression. Conclude that rising cultural assertiveness is one genuine pathway to regionalism but not the whole explanation, that the correct response is diagnosis-specific with recognition for identity grievance and redistribution for material grievance, and that a constitutional statehood demand is not on that account anti-national.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q10", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I Q17

Demand: What is regional disparity? How does it differ from diversity? How Serious is the issue of regional disparity in India? (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Wording confirmed in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I, including the printed capitalisation of the word Serious in the third sentence, which is reproduced here rather than silently corrected. Routed in the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger to this Basic owner with no cross-owner conflict recorded.

Model solution: Answer the three questions in the order the stem asks them, because the commonest failure on this demand is a single blended paragraph on regional imbalance. Answer the first question with a definition. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept. Answer the second question with a contrast and a paired example. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities and is descriptive rather than evaluative; the two are causally independent because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so two regions sharing a linguistic and cultural heritage can show sharply different income and infrastructure levels while two culturally very different regions can be similarly developed. State the consequence of that independence explicitly, since it is the analytical move the examiner is testing: a policy response to diversity and a policy response to disparity are not interchangeable. Answer the third question as an assessment rather than an assertion. Name the indicator families first, namely income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity, and then cite the composite source with its exact edition, the NITI Aayog SDG India Index in its 2023-24 edition, which is the most recently published as of July 2026. Attach the limitation that decides the seriousness verdict: a composite score aggregates many indicators into one number and can therefore mask intra-state variation, so a state may rank well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, which is precisely where sub-regionalism arises. Conclude that disparity remains a serious governance challenge whose severity is understated at state level and clearest below it, that the response is redistribution through targeted infrastructure and fiscal instruments whose mechanics belong to Geography and Polity, and that no state ranking or income figure is claimed here beyond the named source and edition.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I Q17", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Answer the three questions in the order the stem asks them, because the commonest failure on this demand is a single blended paragraph on regional imbalance. Answer the first question with a definition. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept. Answer the second question with a contrast and a paired example.

Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities and is descriptive rather than evaluative; the two are causally independent because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so two regions sharing a linguistic and cultural heritage can show sharply different income and infrastructure levels while two culturally very different regions can be similarly developed. State the consequence of that independence explicitly, since it is the analytical move the examiner is testing: a policy response to diversity and a policy response to disparity are not interchangeable. Answer the third question as an assessment rather than an assertion. Name the indicator families first, namely income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity, and then cite the composite source with its exact edition, the NITI Aayog SDG India Index in its 2023-24 edition, which is the most recently published as of July 2026. Attach the limitation that decides the seriousness verdict: a composite score aggregates many indicators into one number and can therefore mask intra-state variation, so a state may rank well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, which is precisely where sub-regionalism arises. Conclude that disparity remains a serious governance challenge whose severity is understated at state level and clearest below it, that the response is redistribution through targeted infrastructure and fiscal instruments whose mechanics belong to Geography and Polity, and that no state ranking or income figure is claimed here beyond the named source and edition.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: What is regional disparity? How does it differ from diversity? How Serious is the issue of regional disparity in India? (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Answer the three questions in the order the stem asks them, because the commonest failure on this demand is a single blended paragraph on regional imbalance. Answer the first question with a definition. Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept. Answer the second question with a contrast and a paired example. Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities and is descriptive rather than evaluative; the two are causally independent because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so two regions sharing a linguistic and cultural heritage can show sharply different income and infrastructure levels while two culturally very different regions can be similarly developed. State the consequence of that independence explicitly, since it is the analytical move the examiner is testing: a policy response to diversity and a policy response to disparity are not interchangeable. Answer the third question as an assessment rather than an assertion. Name the indicator families first, namely income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity, and then cite the composite source with its exact edition, the NITI Aayog SDG India Index in its 2023-24 edition, which is the most recently published as of July 2026. Attach the limitation that decides the seriousness verdict: a composite score aggregates many indicators into one number and can therefore mask intra-state variation, so a state may rank well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, which is precisely where sub-regionalism arises. Conclude that disparity remains a serious governance challenge whose severity is understated at state level and clearest below it, that the response is redistribution through targeted infrastructure and fiscal instruments whose mechanics belong to Geography and Polity, and that no state ranking or income figure is claimed here beyond the named source and edition.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I Q17", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish regionalism from sub-regionalism and show why the distinction changes the policy response. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The two operate at different scales with different drivers, so a single balanced-development formula addressed to both will under-resolve whichever grievance it was not designed for.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism.
- Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically.
- The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion.

Qualified conclusion: The two operate at different scales with different drivers, so a single balanced-development formula addressed to both will under-resolve whichever grievance it was not designed for.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish regionalism from sub-regionalism and show why the distinction changes the policy...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The two operate at different scales with different drivers, so a single balanced-development formula addressed to both will under-resolve whichever grievance it was not designed for.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Regionalism is the political and social assertion of a region's distinct identity and interest, usually demanding recognition, autonomy or a fairer share of resources and development, and regional attachment, linguistic pride or a constitutional statehood demand is not automatically hostile regionalism. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Sub-regionalism is assertion at a smaller scale within an already-recognised state or region, sometimes involving a demand for administrative recognition or statehood, and its drivers can include identity, representation, development or a combination, none of which follows automatically. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power,

agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The two operate at different scales with different drivers, so a single balanced-development formula addressed to both will under-resolve whichever grievance it was not designed for.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish regionalism from sub-regionalism and show why the distinction changes the policy...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why a constitutional statehood demand should not be treated as automatically anti-national. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Statehood, autonomy and secession are distinct forms rather than stages, and the Indian record is one of accommodation, so the presumption of escalation is unsupported.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder.
- Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.
- The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed.

Qualified conclusion: Statehood, autonomy and secession are distinct forms rather than stages, and the Indian record is one of accommodation, so the presumption of escalation is unsupported.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why a constitutional statehood demand should not be treated as automatically anti-...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Statehood, autonomy and secession are distinct forms rather than stages, and the Indian record is one of accommodation, so the presumption of escalation is unsupported.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Statehood demand within the Union, autonomy demand for greater self-governance and secessionist demand for separation from the Union are three distinct forms with different implications, and they constitute a graded typology rather than a compulsory escalation ladder. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or

legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Statehood, autonomy and secession are distinct forms rather than stages, and the Indian record is one of accommodation, so the presumption of escalation is unsupported.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why a constitutional statehood demand should not be treated as automatically anti-...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the claim that diversity and regional disparity are causally independent axes. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Cultural distinctiveness and economic trajectory are settled by different historical processes, which is why all four combinations of the two axes are observable and why the definitions must be kept separate.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development.
- Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference.
- The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist.
- The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph.

Qualified conclusion: Cultural distinctiveness and economic trajectory are settled by different historical processes, which is why all four combinations of the two axes are observable and why the definitions must be kept separate.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the claim that diversity and regional disparity are causally independent axes. Answer...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Cultural distinctiveness and economic trajectory are settled by different historical processes, which is why all four combinations of the two axes are observable and why the definitions must be kept separate.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Diversity is the objective presence of distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological or historical identities across India's regions, and by itself it implies neither grievance nor unequal development. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The analytical claim that carries this topic is diversity vs disparity as independent axes, because cultural distinctiveness is settled historically while economic trajectory is shaped by separate factors such as colonial-era investment patterns, resource endowment and connectivity, so culturally distinct but prosperous regions and culturally similar but sharply unequal regions both exist. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2024 General Studies Paper-I demand asks what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious the issue is in India, so it rewards a definition, a paired example that separates the two axes and a separately evidenced seriousness assessment rather than one blended paragraph. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Cultural distinctiveness and economic trajectory are settled by different historical processes, which is why all four combinations of the two axes are observable and why the definitions must be kept separate.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the claim that diversity and regional disparity are causally independent axes. Answer...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the limits of a composite index as evidence of how serious regional disparity is in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: A composite score is a benchmarking device rather than a description of lived disadvantage, and its aggregation hides exactly the sub-state variation a seriousness question is usually testing.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used.

- A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level.
- Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion.
- Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference.

Qualified conclusion: A composite score is a benchmarking device rather than a description of lived disadvantage, and its aggregation hides exactly the sub-state variation a seriousness question is usually testing.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the limits of a composite index as evidence of how serious regional disparity is in...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A composite score is a benchmarking device rather than a description of lived disadvantage, and its aggregation hides exactly the sub-state variation a seriousness question is usually testing.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The NITI Aayog SDG India Index is a composite index ranking states and union territories on Sustainable Development Goal-linked indicators, and its most recently published edition as of July 2026 is the 2023-24 edition, which must be cited by exact edition and year whenever a state-wise disparity ranking is used. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A composite index aggregates many indicators into one comparative score, so it can mask intra-state variation in which a state ranks well in aggregate while containing a severely lagging sub-region, and that limitation becomes decisive when a demand asks how serious disparity is below the state level. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Seriousness of disparity is assessed through income, infrastructure, human development and fiscal capacity rather than through linguistic or cultural difference, and naming the indicator family before citing any evidence is what separates an assessment from an assertion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Regional disparity is unequal income, infrastructure, human development or fiscal capacity between regions or states, and it is an outcome-based development concept rather than a description of cultural difference. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: A composite score is a benchmarking device rather than a description of lived disadvantage, and its aggregation hides exactly the sub-state variation a seriousness question is usually testing.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the limits of a composite index as evidence of how serious regional disparity is in...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how identity-driven and disparity-driven regionalism require different responses. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Recognition answers a recognition grievance and redistribution answers a material one, so a diagnosis-first structure is what prevents a policy recommendation from missing the assertion it is meant to address.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package.
- Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved.
- A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule.
- The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion.

Qualified conclusion: Recognition answers a recognition grievance and redistribution answers a material one, so a diagnosis-first structure is what prevents a policy recommendation from missing the assertion it is meant to address.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how identity-driven and disparity-driven regionalism require different responses...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Recognition answers a recognition grievance and redistribution answers a material one, so a diagnosis-first structure is what prevents a policy recommendation from missing the assertion it is meant to address.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Identity-driven regionalism seeks recognition through linguistic status, cultural autonomy or symbolic representation even where economic conditions match neighbouring regions, and it is answered by a recognition response rather than by a development package. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Disparity-driven regionalism seeks redistribution through infrastructure, investment or fiscal transfer even where cultural identity is not distinctly separate, and offering only cultural recognition to such a grievance leaves the material claim unresolved. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A sub-region may combine cultural distinctiveness with perceived economic neglect and under-representation in state-level power, and such compounded cases require recognition and redistribution together, although neither dual disadvantage nor escalation follows as a rule. **Analysis:** Connect

structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The correct response is diagnosis-specific, because recognition addresses an identity grievance while redistribution addresses a development grievance, and applying only one where both drivers operate under-resolves the grievance and can sustain the assertion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Recognition answers a recognition grievance and redistribution answers a material one, so a diagnosis-first structure is what prevents a policy recommendation from missing the assertion it is meant to address.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess how identity-driven and disparity-driven regionalism require different responses....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess reorganisation as a response to regional assertion in India. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Reorganisation has repeatedly converted assertion into accommodation, but a new boundary can reproduce disparity inside itself, so the honest verdict pairs the accommodation record with the internal cost.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed.
- Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy.
- Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record.
- A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity.

Qualified conclusion: Reorganisation has repeatedly converted assertion into accommodation, but a new boundary can reproduce disparity inside itself, so the honest verdict pairs the accommodation record with the internal cost.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess reorganisation as a response to regional assertion in India. Answer in about 300 words.", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Reorganisation has repeatedly converted assertion into accommodation, but a new boundary can reproduce disparity inside itself, so the honest verdict pairs the accommodation record with the internal cost.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines and is the classical Indian example of regionalism accommodated through statehood recognition rather than suppressed. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Creating a new administrative or political unit can answer a recognition grievance while reproducing disparity inside the new unit, so a balanced answer states that reorganisation redistributes the boundary of the problem as well as supplying part of its remedy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Most Indian regional assertions have historically been accommodated through statehood or autonomy arrangements, so secessionist demand is the least common form in the typology and treating every regional movement as a step toward secession misreads the record. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A regionalism answer builds its own case out of grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation, which are the social materials this owner actually holds. Development-planning instruments and fiscal-federalism doctrine enter such an answer as cross-linked evidence rather than as re-derived content, since five-year-plan and current regional-development policy mechanics belong to the Geography regional-development owner while Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine belong to Polity. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Reorganisation has repeatedly converted assertion into accommodation, but a new boundary can reproduce disparity inside itself, so the honest verdict pairs the accommodation record with the internal cost.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess reorganisation as a response to regional assertion in India. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.